with China and BRICS, and a spirit of what some called ‘Nonalignment 2.0’—slowed the pace of the major trends in India’s foreign relations between 1991 and 2008. [9] Relations with the United States and Europe grew increasingly frustrated. The civil nuclear agreement was offset by India’s nuclear liability law of 2010, as well as anti-nuclear sentiments following the Fukushima nuclear accident in Japan in 2011. A low point in India–US relations in late 2013 was a highly visible and public disagreement over the arrest of an Indian diplomat by US authorities in New York, although this incident may have been more a symptom than a cause of poor relations. With Europe, trade talks ground to a halt and political relations were infected by India’s arrest of two Italian marines, who in 2012 killed Kerala fishermen in international waters mistaking them for pirates. India’s ties with Denmark too were held back by a somewhat unusual extradition case, further contaminating India’s relations with the European Union. [10]

New Delhi’s relations with Beijing, despite some convergence on economic and global governance issues, also faced a number of frustrations. In some sense, Beijing brought its newfound confidence after the Olympics and global financial crisis to the border negotiations with India. China issued visas to individuals from Arunachal Pradesh that were stapled rather than affixed to their Indian passports to undermine India’s claims to that state. It also began to issue more maps claiming Indian territory and suspended some military contacts with India’s Northern Command. Despite boundary talks and agreements in 2012 and 2013, Chinese attempts at changing the facts on the ground at Depsang in 2013 led to their most high-profile border stand-off since Sumdorong Chu in the late 1980s and early 1990s. Furthermore, despite India’s attempts at developing a broader consensus with China, it was hampered by economic factors. While India’s initial economic recovery after the global financial crisis in 2009–2010 was strong, the years after 2011 saw a deceleration, compounded by budgets that deterred foreign investors. One bright spot remained India’s relations with Japan, which saw steady progress on military and economic matters, including a visit by Prime Minister Shinzo Abe for Republic Day in 2014.